

Name_____

EDIT NOTE 1: CLAUSES & CONJUNCTIONS

Clause: a group of words

Independent clause: contains a subject and a verb; it stands alone as a complete sentence.

Conjunctions: FANBOYS

For

And

Nor

But

Or

Yet

So

Rule: Two independent clauses joined by a conjunction need a comma before the conjunction.

EX. We must win this game, or we will be out of the playoffs. (two independent clauses)

We must win this game or be out of the playoffs. (only the first clause is independent)

Directions: Edit the following sentences.

1. I tried to do the third problem but I couldn't remember how to do square roots.
2. The elevator has stopped running and everyone is going to be late to work.
3. I had to follow the recipe very carefully for I had never tried to bake a cake before.
4. The bus arrived on time but left 30 minutes late.
5. The drama club will be putting on the play "Hamilton" and I can hardly wait to audition.

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HOMEWORK: EDIT NOTE 1

Directions: Edit the following sentences. If no comma is needed, write NC.

1. Barbara will bring potato salad to the picnic and Marc will bring the cold cuts.
2. Television crews covered the Daytona 500 and the Indianapolis 500 races.
3. We stood and listened but we didn't hear a sound.
4. The Congo River in Africa curves widely and it empties into the Atlantic.
5. The pilot flew a new jet and landed it safely.
6. Jim Thorpe played in several sports but is best remembered for football.
7. Bob likes to watch television and eat popcorn after work.
8. Tori Amos is a singer but she also champions social causes.
9. I usually dislike grammar but I am finding this activity quite fun.
10. She was absolutely frozen with fear for she thought she heard voices in the basement.

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EDIT NOTE 2: INTRODUCTORY DEPENDENT CLAUSES

Dependent clause: depends on another part of the sentence to make it a complete thought.

An **introductory dependent clause** comes at the beginning of a sentence.

Rule: **Introductory dependent clauses are set off by commas.**

EX. When the world series is over, Henry will complete his homework.

(Introductory Dependent Clause)

Words Commonly Used to Begin Dependent Clauses

After	Although	As
Because	Before	If
Provided	Since	Unless
Until	When	Whenever
Wherever	While	

Directions: Underline the dependent clause and punctuate appropriately.

1. Although Bob worked hard, he stayed on the second team.
2. Because everyone seemed satisfied, the plans were not changed.
3. The crowd cheered wildly when Aaron Judge hit a home run.
4. When the recital was finished, Rebecca smiled proudly.
5. Whenever I make brownies, my brother is suddenly my best friend.
6. Dr. Jones gave me a shot after she determined that I had the flu.
- *7. Write a sentence with an introductory dependent clause.

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HOMEWORK: EDIT NOTE 2

Directions: Underline the dependent clause and punctuate appropriately.

1. Although Maria and I often disagree I always respect her opinions.
2. Because no women were permitted on the Elizabethan stage female roles were acted by men.
3. Many new nations have economic difficulties because they are not prepared for self-government.
4. We had to take a shortcut so that we could get to the station in time.
5. Although wages are generally higher than they were ten years ago the cost of living has gone up considerably.
6. When we arrived that afternoon it was clear that she wasn't expecting guests.
7. If your grades are below average try taking detailed notes during class.
8. She was overwhelmed with stage fright when she saw the crowd before her.
9. As soon as the snow starts falling the snow plows go out.
10. John set the table while Martin cooked the hamburgers.

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EDIT NOTE 3: RESTRICTIVE & NONRESTRICTIVE CLAUSES

A dependent clause that presents added information not needed to keep the meaning of the sentence intact (a nonrestrictive clause) is set off by commas.

EX. The farm, which has a beautiful yellow barn, sells apples and pumpkins.

A dependent clause that comes in the middle or the end of a sentence and is necessary to the meaning (a restrictive clause) is not set off by commas.

EX. The farm that we passed a mile back sells apples and pumpkins.

Please Note: Many people incorrectly use *that* and *which* interchangeably. Use the word *that* to introduce restrictive clauses and the word *which* to introduce nonrestrictive clauses.

Directions: Underline the dependent clause and punctuate the sentence if necessary.

1. The skirt that I want is simply too expensive.
2. Writers who are just important to success as the actors seldom get any of the glory.
3. My mother told me to marry a man who can cook.
4. The cat which recently had kittens drinks at least a pint of milk a day.
5. Lynn who had been accepted for admission to several colleges was awarded a scholarship to Berkeley.
6. The river that empties into the Gulf of Mexico is called the Mississippi.
7. The Mississippi River which empties into the Gulf of Mexico has inspired much great American writing.
- *8. Write a sentence with a nonrestrictive clause that comes in the middle or at the end of the sentence.

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HOMEWORK: EDIT NOTE 3

Directions: Underline the dependent clause and punctuate the sentence if necessary.

1. Neil DeGrasse Tyson who is the Director of the Hayden Planetarium in New York wrote several books on astrophysics.
2. The early experiences that Margaret Mead had as an anthropologist are recorded in her book *Blackberry Winter*.
3. Anyone who appreciates color and movement will love seeing Alexander Calder's mobiles.
4. The Homecoming Parade which is sponsored by the student council will feature twenty-three floats this year.
5. The driver who caused the wreck was traveling at an excessive speed.
6. The house which used to belong to my parents was built in 1910.
7. Any student who parks a car in the school parking lot must have an authorized permit.
8. My car which is seven years old simply refuses to start on cold mornings.
9. The speech which was persuasive promised to lower taxes and improve health care.
10. Sisters Serena and Venus Williams have faced off almost thirty times in professional tennis tournaments.

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EDIT NOTE 4: APPOSITIVES

An appositive is a word or group of words that follows a noun and identifies it or gives more information. An appositive is set off by commas.

EX:

Mrs. Aber and Mrs. Salvato, our English teachers, are friends.

We visited the Adams Library, one of the oldest in America.

Rule: When an appositive is so closely related to the word it modifies that it appears to be part of that word, no comma is necessary. An appositive of this kind is called a restrictive appositive. It is usually one word. (Hint: when the appositive is before the noun, no comma is needed).

EX:

My nephew Jim

The American gymnast Simone Biles

My friend Julia

Directions: Underline the appositive and punctuate the sentence correctly.

1. Tom Brady the star quarterback of the Bucs injured his shoulder in last night's game.
2. Mother's guest the distinguished Ms. Worthall was not amused.
3. F. Scott Fitzgerald's *The Great Gatsby* the book I have often told you about is considered a great American novel.
4. The door was opened by the butler a tall man with brooding eyes.
5. Langston Hughes a poet and playwright from Missouri wrote "Dream Deferred."
6. My friend Brian plays the drums.
7. The head nurse Barbara instructs the aides.
8. Some Chinese food is stir-fried in a wok a rounded metal pan.
- *9. Write a sentence with an appositive.

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HOMEWORK: EDIT NOTE 4

Directions: Underline the appositive and punctuate the sentence correctly.

1. India already an enormous country has a rapidly growing population.
2. Ally my older sister just graduated from college.
3. The television show a documentary illuminated Lorraine Hansberry's success as a writer.
4. Mrs. Murphy our science teacher is creating an astronomy club in the spring.
5. The thesaurus a book of synonyms is helpful in vocabulary development.
6. The farmer a hardworking man in his thirties lived off of his land.
7. English a challenging subject is crucial in the development of writing skills.
8. My friend Jess has a huge trampoline in her backyard.
9. The mayor's proposal a plan for charter schools in New York City was met with vehement criticism.
10. Holden Caulfield the narrator of *The Catcher in the Rye* has been called a poor role model for teenagers.

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EDIT NOTE 5: SEMICOLONS

Vary sentences by joining two closely related sentences with a semicolon and no conjunction.

EX:

She stared intently at the stranger; all eyes followed her as she moved toward him.

The movie was filmed in France; the producers rented all the homes in a small village for two months.

Use a semicolon and a comma in joining two closely related sentences that include a conjunctive adverb, such as "however," "otherwise," "therefore," or a phrase like "for example," "in fact," or "for instance."

EX:

At first, the painting was considered worthless; however, it recently sold for one million dollars.

Universities have many challenges; for example, bringing together diverse students.

Directions: Edit the following sentences for commas and semicolons.

1. The rain had finally stopped a few rays of sunshine were pushing their way through the clouds.
2. Her answer was correct but your answer was far more interesting.
3. Ted plays varsity baseball in college in fact he would like to try out for a major league team when he graduates.
4. The doctor closed the door he asked us to return to the waiting room.
5. The snowstorm made traveling difficult therefore we arrived at our destination two hours later than scheduled.
6. I lost my keys on the subway and Rebecca didn't have enough money for a taxi ride.
7. The test was long and difficult however everyone in the class managed to finish it on time.
8. This novel is a classic it has been read by students for over fifty years.
9. Jennifer always volunteers at the soup kitchen she finds the experience very rewarding.
10. The wind chill factor can make the air feel much colder than it actually is in fact sometimes a temperature of zero degrees can feel like fifty degrees below zero.

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HOMEWORK: EDIT NOTE 5

Directions: Edit the following sentences using commas and semicolons.

1. My grandmother loves weeding and gardening I do not.
2. There are a number of spectacular musicals on Broadway however I have only seen *Hamilton*.
3. Titanium was discovered by William Gregor of England but it was named by Martin Klaproth of Germany.
4. Gretta has fair skin therefore she burns quite easily.
5. Africa is a continent of contrasts for example the Sahara is nothing like the Congo.
6. Shark attacks have occurred along Florida's coastline they are also common in South Africa and Australia.
7. The storyline is interesting and the characters are well developed.
8. Nearsightedness is the condition of having difficulty seeing things that are far away farsightedness is the opposite condition.
9. The movie was produced on a low budget nevertheless it is one of the year's best releases.
10. Down jackets are very warm they are good for watching outdoor sports in cold weather.

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EDIT NOTE 6: SEMICOLONS (CONTINUED)

A semicolon is used between main clauses joined by a conjunction if the clause before the conjunction contains commas.

EX.

Henry will invite Jessica, Brianna, and Michael; and Doug will ask two of his friends.

Rob won't try Mexican, Greek, or Chinese food; nor will he try anything that looks at all unusual.

A semicolon is used between a series of phrases if they contain commas.

EX.

The auctions will be held on Monday, September 10; Tuesday, September 11; and Friday, September 14.

Leo painted a picture of Maria, his mother; Christopher, his nephew; and Julio, his cousin.

Directions: Edit the following sentences for commas and semicolons.

1. We had canned soup canned beans and canned milk but no one had a can opener.
2. The prize winners came from Cleveland Ohio from Austin Texas and from Queens New York.
3. The ancient Egyptians used vinegar as a food preservative a medicine and a cleaner and it is still used these ways today.
4. Florida is called the Sunshine State California the Golden State and Louisiana the Pelican State.
5. Michelle Obama and Melania Trump are considered fashion icons but none compare to First Lady Jacqueline Kennedy Onassis.
6. Mark used the proper tools read the instructions and worked slowly but the bicycle he put together fell apart in one week.
7. The turkey buzzard only looks something like a turkey it actually is a member of the vulture family.
8. The page contained ads for cases straps lenses and film but it did not contain an ad for cameras.
9. At 6:30 we watched the news at 7:30 we switched to our favorite comedy.
10. The store was going out of business however they had not yet reduced their prices.

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HOMEWORK: EDIT NOTE 6

Directions: Edit the following sentences for commas and semicolons.

1. We drove through Cheyenne Wyoming Salt Lake City Utah and Reno Nevada.
2. The painter washed painted and papered the walls and the house looked new.
3. Food coloring is used in many foods for instance hot dogs aren't really red.
4. The storm was very severe in fact power lines were blown down all over the state.
5. I will bring hamburgers hot dogs potato chips and soda to the picnic and Bob will bring the desserts.
6. The waitress brought just our salads the sandwiches weren't ready yet.
7. My little sister loves Barney Kermit and Miss Piggy but she is terrified of Cookie Monster.
8. Emma Willard founded the first women's college in 1821 it was called Troy Female Seminary.
9. I can't really afford to buy a car however I truly need one for work.
10. I earned money babysitting walking dogs and mowing lawns but I was still broke.

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EDIT NOTE 7: POSSESSIVES

A possessive form of a singular noun is made by adding an apostrophe and s. ('s). EX. doctor's, family's, James's (Note: James' is also acceptable)

If a plural noun does not end in "s", add an apostrophe and "s" to form the possessive ('s). EX: children's, men's, people's

If a plural noun does end in "S", add only the apostrophe to form the possessive.

EX: guitarists', parents', senators'

When the names of two or more persons are used to show joint ownership, only the name of the last person mentioned is given the possessive form. Add an apostrophe or an apostrophe and "S" in accord with the spelling of that name.

EX: Mom and Dad's idea, Michael and Anna's project

If the names of two or more persons are used to show separate ownership, each name is given the possessive form.

EX: Spielberg's and Lucas's films, Marie's and Jonathan's essays

Directions: Fill in the blank with the correct form of the possessive noun.

1. The son of Mr. Holland is Mr. _____ son.
2. The daughter of Mrs. Jones is Mrs. _____ daughter.
3. The governor of Massachusetts is _____ governor.
4. The dog of the neighbor is the _____ dog.
5. The dog of the neighbors is the _____ dog.
6. The books of Bob and Ira (separate ownership) are _____ books.

Name _____

HOMEWORK: EDIT NOTE 7

Directions: Circle the correct use of the possessive apostrophe in each sentence.

1. The class is exasperated because (Mr. Clark's / Mr. Clarks') puppy still does not have a name.
2. According to all the (mens' / men's) fashion designers, wearing sneakers are now acceptable in all settings.
3. (Noahs / Noah's) essay was wonderful to read because it showed such improvement.
4. (Tony's and Martina's / Tony and Martina's) partnership proved to be one of the best in the class.
5. *The Perks of Being a Wallflower* is one of (Elena's/ Elenas') favorite books.
6. Cody met with Mr. Walsh's (Principals' / Principal's) Advisory Committee to discuss some new ideas for the school.
7. Tom (Bradys' / Brady's) talent surpasses that of almost every player in the NFL today.
8. Her (parent's / parents') decision to fly the family to Los Angeles was made at the last minute.
9. The three (days' / day's) journey exhausted everyone.
10. The (cars' / car's) owner was an elderly gentleman.

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EDIT NOTE 8: INDEFINITE & PERSONAL PRONOUNS

Indefinite Pronoun: a pronoun that does not refer to any person, amount, or thing in particular (ie/ anything, something, anyone, everyone).

Use an apostrophe and "s" ('s) to form the possessive of indefinite pronouns.

EX: Educating children is everybody's responsibility.

Michael and Jennifer often do each other's chores.

The apostrophe is NOT used to form the possessive of a personal pronoun.

Personal Pronouns: I, you, he, she, it, we, they, me, him, her, us, and them.

EX: The dog hurt **its** paw.

The radio is **hers**.

Directions: Add apostrophes where necessary.

1. I left the restaurant with someone elses coat.
2. The decreasing demand for our product is nobodys fault.
3. Its a shame that no one brought gifts to the party.
4. The plans for the new building didn't meet everyones approval.
5. It was somebodys suggestion to go to the movies.
6. The new puppy is hers, but her brother often takes care of it.
7. If you use anothers idea, you must give that person credit.
8. Take anyones coat, but make sure you return it this evening.
9. The bear left its cave in search of food.
10. The refurbished apartment is his.

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HOMEWORK: EDIT NOTE 8

Directions: Add an apostrophe where necessary.

1. A leopard can't change its spots.
2. Each ones time is recorded separately after the track meet.
3. He seems to need everybodys attention when he enters the room.
4. The new sports car is theirs.
5. It is somebody elses responsibility to make sure that the building is locked.
6. Whose shoes are in front of the door?
7. It is everyones hope that we won't have homework on Friday.
8. It is nobodys business what I am doing this weekend.
9. The dictionary is his.
10. It is nobody elses decision where you attend college.

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EDIT NOTE 9 -SUBJECT -VERB AGREEMENT

Subject-verb agreement means that the subject and the verb must agree in number.

You must be able to recognize whether a pronoun is singular or plural to determine which verb form to use.

Singular Pronouns: each, either, neither, one, everyone, everybody, no one, nobody, anyone, anybody, someone, somebody

Plural Pronouns: several, few, both, many

The pronouns some, all, most, any, and none may be either singular or plural.

EX.

Some of the food was eaten. (quantity)

All of the furniture looks comfortable. (quantity)

Some of the apples were eaten. (number)

All of the chairs look comfortable. (number)

These pronouns are singular when they refer to a quantity of something and plural when they refer to a number of things thought of individually.

Directions: Try the following on your own:

1. Many of us actually (likes, like) long books.
2. Some of the children (seems, seem) shy.
3. Somebody in the audience (was, were) snoring.
4. Each of us (tries, try) to outdo the other.
5. Either of these hats (suit, suits) you.
6. Few of the pies (was, were) left after the sale.
7. Sometimes everyone in the office (works, work) late.
8. Neither the dress nor the hat (fit, fits).
9. Each of the farmers (uses, use) new machinery.
10. Neither of the drivers (was, were) hurt in the accident.

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HOMEWORK: EDIT NOTE 9

Directions: Choose the correct form of the verb.

1. Neither of the books (interests, interest) me.
2. Most of the people (has, have) returned to their seats
3. Not one of the scientists (knows, know) the answer.
4. Either of those coats (looks, look) good on you.
5. Not one of my friends (has, have) called me.
6. Few in our little town (has, have) been out of the state
7. Both cars (is, are) low on gas.
8. (Has, Have) either of the boats been found?
9. It was clear that one of the planes (was, were) in trouble
10. Several students in this class (has, have) made that mistake.
11. Everyone in the old wooden stands (was, were) in peril
12. One of the passengers (has, have) picked up my bag.
13. Everyone in the villages (was, were) decorating the streets.
14. Neither of these mountains (is, are) as high as Mt. McKinley
15. One of the visitors (has, have) lost a camera.
16. We believe that some of these fish (is, are) poisonous.
17. Everybody on these islands (is, are) friendly.
18. You will find that few of the courses (is, are) very difficult.
19. (Is, Are) either of these bikes yours?
20. Each of the rooms (is, are) overcrowded.

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EDIT NOTE 10: COMPOUND SUBJECTS

When a compound subject is joined by “and,” the verb is plural.

EX. Mood, character, and plot **are** elements of the short story.

When a compound subject is joined by “or” or “nor,” the verb agrees with the subject nearer the verb.

EX. Neither the speaker **nor the listeners were** intimidated by the protesters.

EX. Neither the listeners **nor the speaker was** intimidated by the protesters.

Note: Review edit note 9 - indefinite pronouns.

Directions: Circle the correct verb.

1. Either Rebecca or Raphael (have, has) taken your book back to the library.
2. One of the movies (was, were) considered too sophisticated for children.
3. Neither the students nor their teacher (wants, want) to miss the documentary film on mountain climbing
4. Until now, every one of the attempts to restore Da Vinci’s painting *The Last Supper* (has, have) ended in failure.
5. Suntan lotion and mosquito repellent (is, are) in short supply at the local store.
6. Many of the member schools of the state athletic association (refuses, refuse) to abide by the new academic standards.
7. Neither the class advisors nor the principal (is, are) going.
8. Few of the politicians (admit, admits) to accepting the donation.
9. The debate over the rule changes (has, have) apparently thrown the meeting into a deadlock.
10. The terms simile and metaphor (is, are) used in the study of poetry.

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HOMEWORK: EDIT NOTE 10

Directions: Circle the verb that makes the sentence grammatically correct.

1. The imagery used by Emily Dickinson and the structure of her verse (has, have) been covered in English class.
2. The view from Edinburgh Castle walls (is, are) unforgettable.
3. One or both of the Shakespearean plays about Henry IV (is, are) likely to be performed this summer.
4. Some of the signs of damage to the ozone in the upper atmosphere (has, have) already been detected.
5. Not one of the situation comedies on TV (seem, seems) particularly funny.
6. Neither the statement of the problems nor the solution suggested for them (is, are) clear until you have done the research.
7. James Baldwin, alongside Richard Wright and Ralph Ellison, (ranks, rank) as one of the major black writers of the twentieth century.
8. The City Council and the Board of Governors together (constitutes, constitute) the committee.
9. Neither Gary nor his neighbors (was, were) home for the parade.
10. New York and Tokyo (is, are) sites of stock exchanges.